

BREWERYTOWN

Displacement and Neighborhood Changes



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01 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This report provides a comprehensive analysis of Brewerytown, a neighborhood located in the Lower North District of Philadelphia. It examines the characteristics and transformations observed over the past decade (2012-2022) across key areas such as demography, education, economic development, household composition, rent, income and poverty, employment, and commuting patterns. The report also identifies the opportunities and challenges currently facing the neighborhood. To gain a holistic understanding of the neighborhood the report drew from a variety of data sources such as: OnTheMap, Census Data, local news articles and local business pages.

The findings highlight an ongoing process of gentrification that is reshaping Brewerytown. The long standing low-income Black community in Brewerytown that has been living in the neighborhood for the past 50 years has experienced pressure in the past decade due to the surge in development, influx of younger residents, and increasing rental costs. This threatens to uproot the core community of the neighborhood.

From 2012 to 2022, Brewerytown experienced improved education outcomes, rising home values, and racial diversity. The neighborhood's economy changed from being driven by blue-collar to white-collar industries, particularly in sectors like real estate and education. Looking ahead to 2030, Brewerytown is projected to continue growing, both in population and employment. Moreover, during the past decade, the neighborhood's labor force expanded, with a marked increase in residents aged 25 to 44. This growth has contributed to a significant decline in unemployment and non-participation in the labor force, surpassing citywide trends.

While economic improvements are evident, challenges persist, particularly with racial disparities in unemployment rates. The unemployment rate remains disproportionately higher among Black residents, indicating economic benefits were not universal. Additionally, household growth in Brewerytown outpaced the city, with significant increases in multi-person living situations, highlighting a shift towards shared housing. Despite an overall decrease in average household size, the growth in non-family households suggests this is a response to rental pressures. The projected population increase will also likely place strain on the neighborhood's infrastructure, including public transportation services, sewer capacity, and street safety.

Despite these challenges, the surge in educational attainment and professional job opportunities offers a foundation for future economic inclusivity. Meanwhile, the conversion of vacant lots into mixed-income developments presents an opportunity to create inclusive housing and mitigate the tension caused by luxury developments.



Figure 1: Image on the left is of a residential street in Brewerytown. Image on the right is the Brewerytown Community Garden.

All images in this report were produced by the team.

02 GEOGRAPHICAL CONTEXT

Located in the Lower North District of Philadelphia, Brewerytown is situated near the Schuylkill River and close to both Center City and Fairmount. As of 2022, it is home to nearly 8,000 households with over sixteen thousand people. The neighborhood is roughly bounded by Cecil B Moore Ave. to the North, Parrish Street to the South, and 25th Street to the East. This study relies on the analysis of five census tracts: 136.02, 137.01, 137.02, 138 and 149. While the border of these tracts combined extend beyond the general definition of Brewerytown's geographical boundaries, they comprise a slightly larger area than the neighborhood itself, which allows for an all-encompassing analysis of Brewerytown's demographic, social-economic, and housing characteristics and the nature of their transformation.

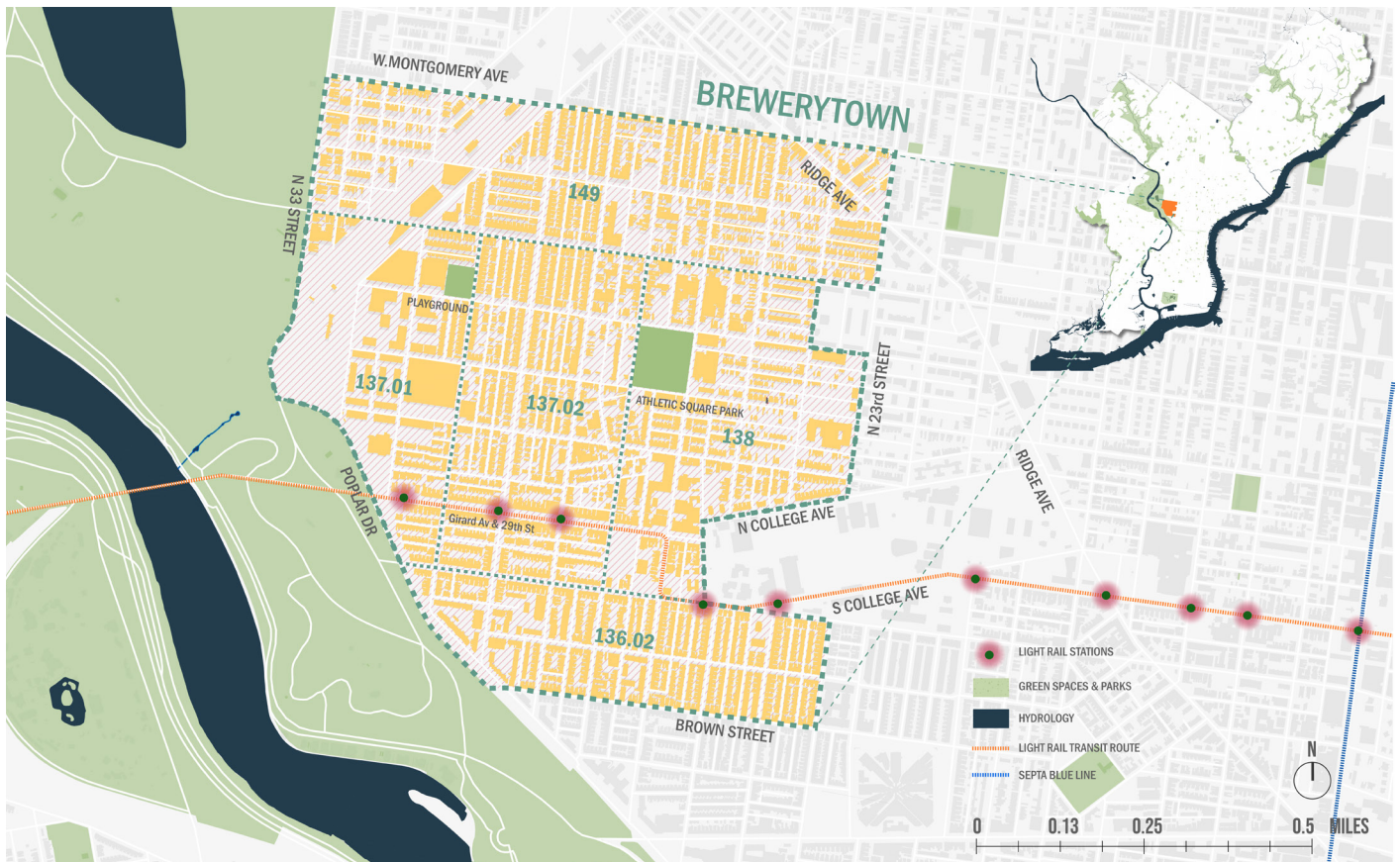


Figure 2: Geographical Context of the Brewerytown Neighborhood

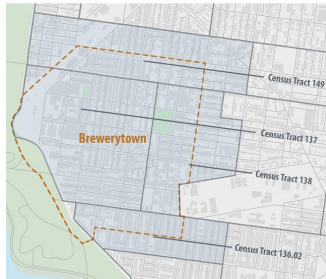
Figure 2 illustrates the basic layout of Brewerytown. In addition to the boundary streets, the map highlights West Girard Avenue, a commercial corridor in the southern part of Brewerytown. It also marks two major transit lines running near this area, as well as notable public spaces, including two sports grounds and a neighborhood garden, which are primarily located in the northern part of the neighborhood.

The data in this article comes from the American Community Survey (ACS) 5-year estimates published in 2012 and 2022. Figure 3 compares Brewerytown's boundaries with the census tracts selected for this analysis. Although Census Tract 137 split into Census Tracts 137.01 and 137.02 in 2020, the overall boundary did not change. Therefore, the geographic area used in this analysis remained consistent throughout the decade in focus.

03 HISTORY

History of Brewerytown

2010 Census Tracts of Brewerytown



2020 Census Tracts of Brewerytown

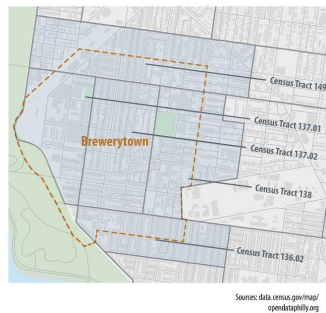


Figure 3: Census Tract Division Changes

Brewerytown, as the name suggests, was born from the strong beer culture that flourished in the neighborhood starting in the late 1800s. As thousands of German immigrants traveled to Philadelphia to escape war and famine from the 1840s through the 1870s, they brought with them their culture and customs. In the case of the German community in Brewerytown, that meant beer. The neighborhood's location next to the Schuylkill River proved ideal for making beer¹, and dozens of breweries emerged to serve the burgeoning population. However, the heyday of brewing in Brewerytown was short-lived. Prohibition caused the rapid decline of the brewing industry in Philadelphia and the start of the decline of Brewerytown. The loss of its main industry and a continued economic downturn from the Great Depression caused job and population loss.

In the 1940s, the post-war boom in subsidized suburban housing, coupled with "white flight," saw a dramatic shift in the neighborhood's racial composition. The once predominantly white population dwindled to just 7% by the 1990s, while African American families became the majority, forming a long-standing and resilient community. The timeline in Figure 4 provides a general overview of Brewerytown historical shifts and how that coincide with the developmental trend of the neighborhood.

Only towards the end of the 20th century did the economic fortunes of Brewerytown begin to recover, especially after its certification as a National Historic District in 1991². The Breweries that had been the economic engine of the neighborhood proved ideal for conversions to loft spaces, food halls, and even small microbreweries. In recent decades, Brewerytown has experienced renewed interest from external developers and local economic growth, paving the way for new changes and dynamics in this historic neighborhood. Brewerytown's present-day strengths and weaknesses are products of its long history. While the community shows improving outcomes across factors, including education, income, and employment, it remains starkly divided.

To analyze changes in the neighborhood, census tract data from 2012 and 2022 was compiled from tracts including and extending beyond the traditional neighborhood boundaries. The following map (Figure 3) demonstrates the boundaries of this study and the differences between the area of collected data and the perceived neighborhood boundaries of Brewerytown.

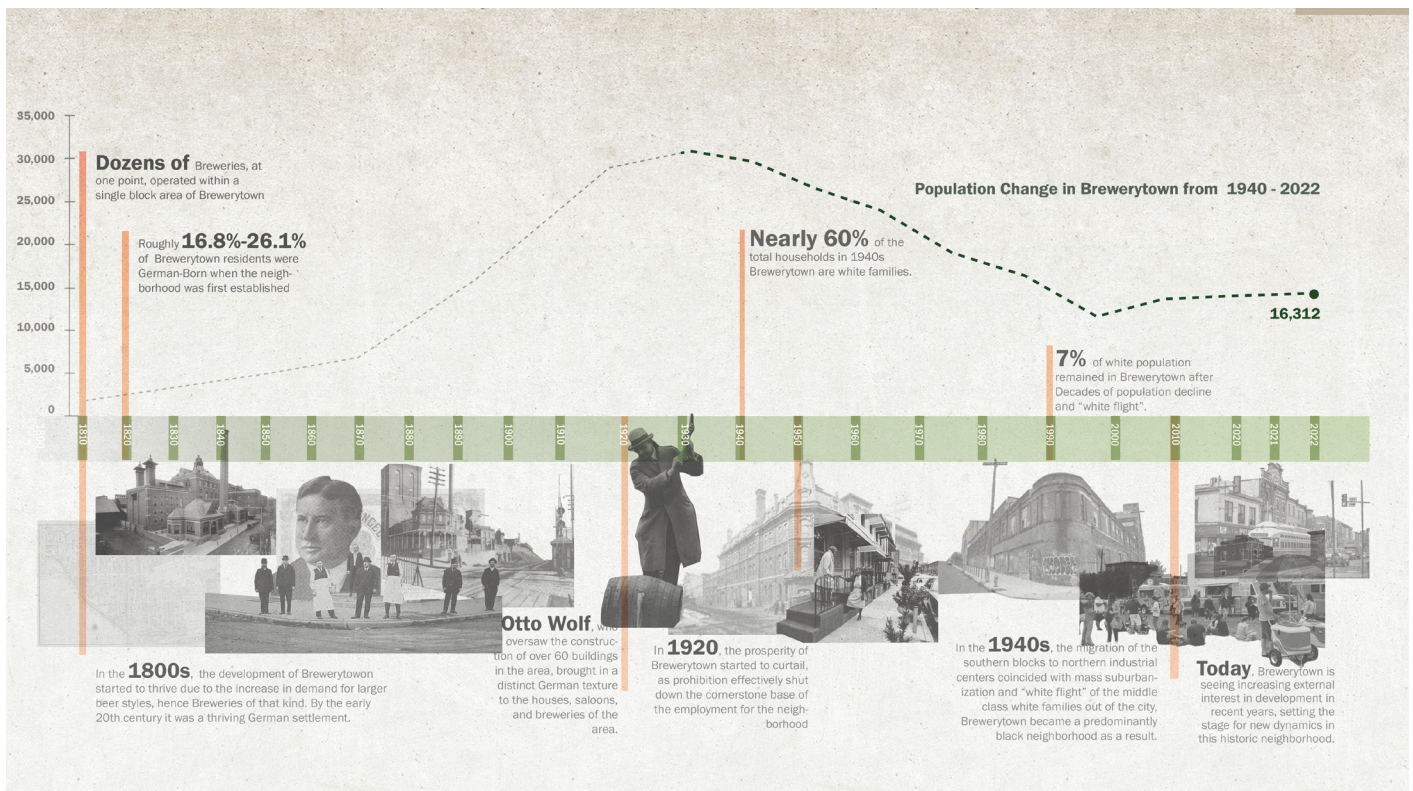


Figure 4: Brewerytown's Historic timeline

04 DEMOGRAPHICS

Overview

Over the decade of 2012-2022, Brewerytown experienced substantial growth in its overall population. As of 2022, approximately 16,312 people live in the neighborhood, a 20% increase from its 2012 total population of 13,274, much higher than Philadelphia's 5.9% city-wide population growth. The scale and pattern of population growth varied across the five census tracts within the neighborhood: From 2012 to 2022, tracts 137 and 149 saw significantly more growth than tracts 136.02 and 148. Tract 149 grew 34.5%, from 3,207 to 4,318 people, while tract 137, split into 137.01 and 137.02 by 2022, increased 35%, from 4,380 to 5,942 people in total. Comparatively, tracts 138 and 136.02 experienced modest growth.

Demographic Change by Age Group

Over 2012 - 2022, Brewerytown's over-65 population grew **29.4%**, and the 25-44 age group grew about **60%**. In Philadelphia, the growth rates were **20%** and **14%**, respectively.

Brewerytown's population growth is driven by a sharp rise in working-age residents, with the 25-34 group growing 83.5% and the 35-44 group 35.3%. Together, they account for a 60% increase in ages 25-44, contributing 2,844 of the 3,038 total growth from 2012 to 2022. The influence of this specific age group on Brewerytown's population growth becomes clear when considering the total increase of 3,038 people in the neighborhood, with individuals aged 25-44 accounting for 2,844 of that growth. The composition of the 25-34 age cohort grew from 19.8% in 2012 to 29.5% in 2022, and the 35-44 age cohort has also increased by 1.4% in its compositional share (Figure 5).

Changes in Racial Composition

In addition to the overall population growth, the influx of younger residents in Brewerytown also coincides with a significant rise in racial diversity. Historically, Brewerytown is a predominantly Black neighborhood. Over the past decade there was an increase in the White and Asian populations. The neighborhood's White population grew by nearly 40% while the Asian population nearly doubled. Although the Black population remained stable from a numeric standpoint, the population declined by approximately 13% in proportion of the total population (Figure 6). Given Brewerytown was a predominantly Black neighborhood prior to recent changes, this highlights the impacts of urban change on long-standing communities and presents as an indicator of broader gentrification patterns in the area as long-standing community members are being increasingly displaced and marginalized.

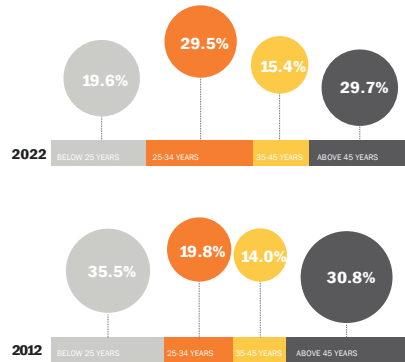


Figure 5: Brewerytown Age Composition 2012 & 2022

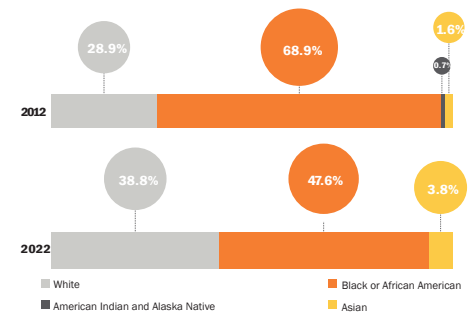


Figure 6: Brewerytown Racial Composition 2012 & 2022

The Out-Migration of Long-Standing Residents

Brewerytown's population growth is driven by a 93.3% increase in residents migrating from other parts of Philadelphia by 2021, reflecting its growing desirability. However, this influx contrasts with a sharp decline in long-term residents. By 2022, 57% of owner-occupied units housed post-2012 movers, a 55% increase. Of 6,606 pre-2010 households, only 3,451 remained, with half leaving the neighborhood, highlighting a shift from long-term residents to newer households.

Population Projection

To project Brewerytown's future population for 2030, the base assumption is the neighborhood will maintain its recent consistent growth trajectory observed over the past decade, driven largely by the influx of younger, working-age residents. By extrapolating this trend using the simple trend model, we anticipate similar population growth rates from 2022 to 2030. So here, by extending the same absolute change with the AAAC method we project the neighborhood's future population in 2030 to be around 18,742. (Figure 7).

SIMPLE TREND MODEL

Year	Population	Absolute Growth	AAAC
2012	13,274		
2022	16,312	3038	304

PROJECTION RESULTS

Year: 2030	AAAC method: 18742
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Figure 7: Brewerytown 2030 Population Projection

05 EDUCATION

One of the greatest changes in neighborhood outcomes between 2012 and 2022 for Brewerytown is education. Residents of Brewerytown are now much more likely to have a bachelor's or master's degree. Among residents aged over 25, the share of those holding a bachelor's degree saw an approximate ten-percentage-point increase from 15.1% to 26.5%, and the residents with a master's degree or higher increased from 17.2% to 26.7%. The growth in overall educational attainment level in Brewerytown outpaced the citywide trend, as the bachelor's share grew from 13.7% to 18.8%, and graduate degree holders from 9.6% to 14.8% in Philadelphia (Figure 8). The level of higher-level education in Brewerytown started off with higher rates than Philadelphia (in 2012) and has continued to grow at faster rates than Philadelphia. Geographically, Brewerytown sits between Temple and University City where both Drexel and the University of Pennsylvania are located. The 49 bus route connects Brewerytown to University City, which was introduced in 2019³. Thus, populations from both areas who either work or attend the Universities live in the neighborhood and could contribute to the increasing levels of higher educational attainment.

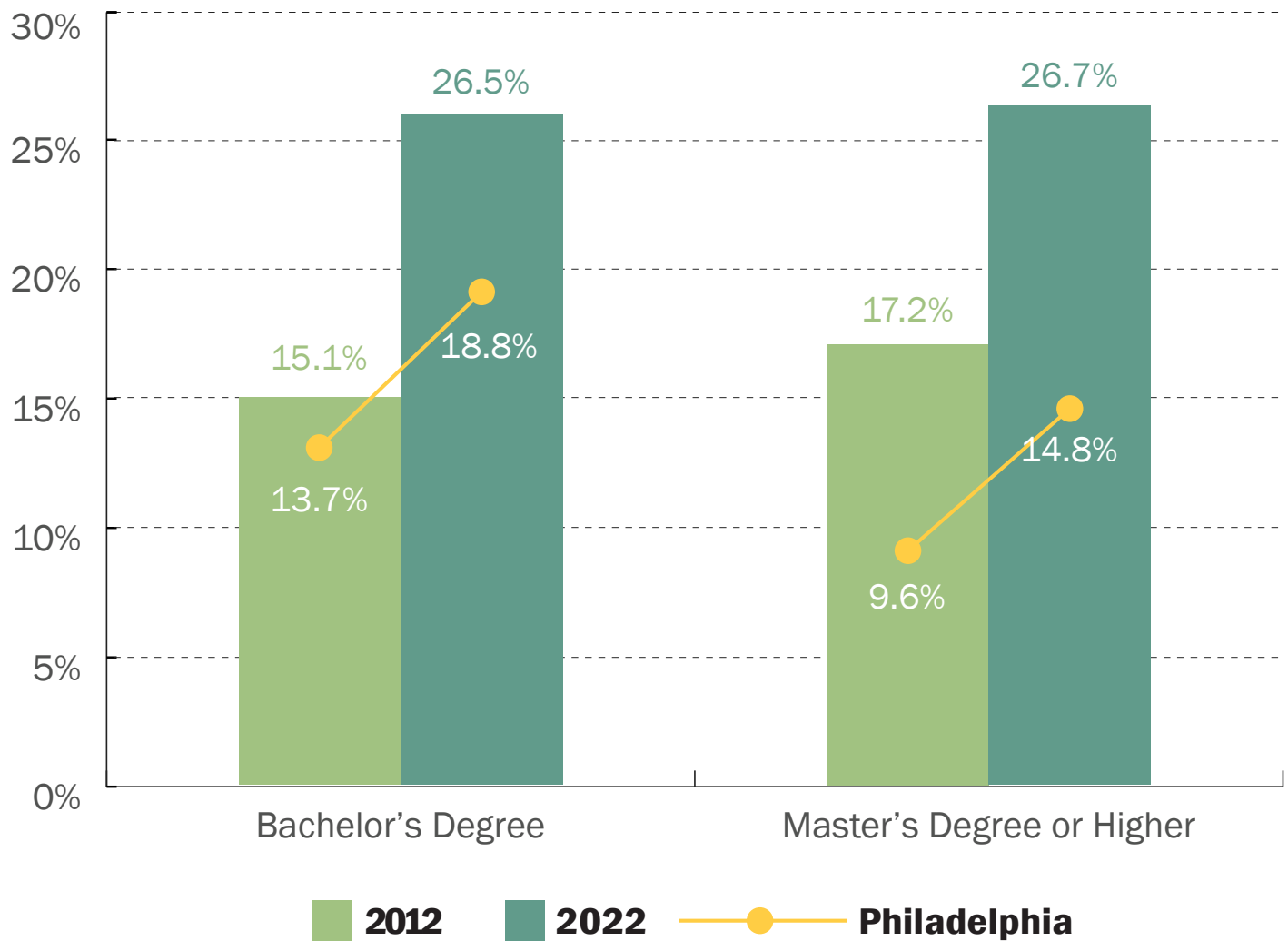


Figure 8: Higher Educational Attainment

Additionally, the number of residents with only lower educational attainment dropped. Those with a high school education with no diploma decreased from 13.5% to 6.9%, and the number of residents with only a high school diploma also dropped from 31.2% to 20.6%. In sum, less than 10% of residents in 2022 had no degree at all (high school, college, etc.), versus 16.8% of residents in 2012.

06 ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

Overview

An increase in Brewerytown's job sector is crucial for the neighborhood's continued growth and prosperity. From 2012 to 2021, 556 new private jobs emerged in Brewerytown resulting in an average annual growth rate of 7.64%, vastly outpacing Philadelphia's private job market annual growth rate of 0.15% (Figure 9). The difference in growth rate is due to Philadelphia's basic industries remaining constant from 2012 to 2021 -- these included Finance and Insurance, Professional, Scientific and Technical Services, Educational Services, Health Care and Social Assistance -- while Brewerytown's basic industries changed (figure 10). In 2012, all Brewerytown's basic industries excluding Health Care and Social Assistance were blue collar job sectors, but by 2021 the basic industries shifted to white-collar job sectors (Figure 10). Two thresholds were used to determine the basic industries: a location quotient greater than 1 and having a share of 5% or more of all private jobs. A location quotient greater than one indicates a sector is more competitive in a specific area (Brewerytown) than the larger reference area (Philadelphia). An industry that accounts for less than 5% of all jobs in the neighborhood is unlikely to drive economic growth.

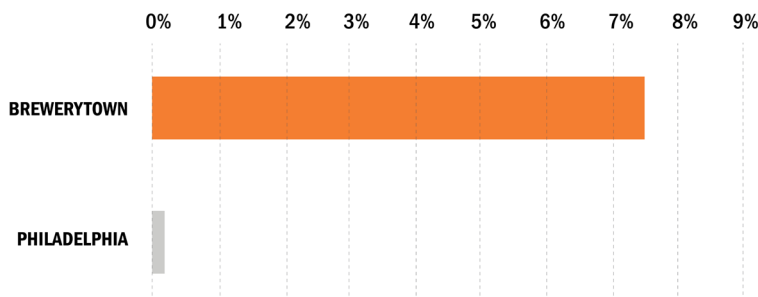


Figure 9: Average Annual Growth Rate

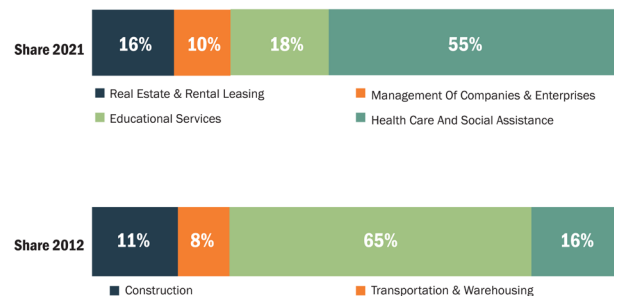


Figure 10: Share of Basic Industries

Business and Development

Management of Companies and Enterprises, and Real Estate and Rental and Leasing became basic industries in 2021. The inclusion of Real Estate and Rental and Leasing as a basic industry reflects the planned increase in development outlined in Philadelphia's 2035 comprehensive plan in response to anticipated population growth. Growth in development means there are more available units that need to be showcased by real estate professionals. With an increase in white collar jobs there is a demand increase for jobs such as accounting which fall within the Management of Companies and Enterprises sector. This sector services Brewerytown and Philadelphia. Blue collar job sectors such as Construction, Transportation and Warehousing also require accountants and bookkeepers; however, if these businesses are large franchises, then this work is completed by people working outside of Brewerytown. Businesses within the Accommodation and Food Services sector also need accountants and bookkeepers but this work is likely completed in-house by the owner, or an employee holding multiple roles. Thus, the shift towards the white-collar sector in Brewerytown creates a need for specialization which is serviced by the Management of Companies and Enterprises sector.

Educational Services

The Educational Services Industry experienced a large growth increasing from 7 people in 2012 to 125 people in 2021. The expansion in this sector is likely due to increasing demands for school-related services as the population increases and is more educated. The education services are geared towards early education, for instance the Innovative Learning Center of Philadelphia opened in 2018 and provides childcare for children ages 6 months to 6 years old. Although family household sizes are shrinking in Brewerytown (later elaborated on in the Household Composition section), the growth in adult educational attainment drove more educational services in the neighborhood. The growth in early education services can also stem from the increase in jobs in Brewerytown. Childcare services provide for people living and/or working in the neighborhood as well as nearby neighborhoods such as Fairmount. Since more people work in the neighborhood, those with children need childcare. The childcare facilities in Brewerytown provide convenience to working parents. Hence, the growth in Educational Services connects to an increase in employment and higher education attainment in Brewerytown.

Health care and social assistance

Health care and Social Assistance is the consistent basic sector in Brewerytown. Many of the businesses within the Health Care sector in Brewerytown are caregiving facilities and clinics. Although



Figure 11: Image of Girard Avenue, the Commercial Corridor in Brewerytown

Health Care and Social Assistance remained a basic industry, its share decreased from 42% in 2012 to 33% in 2021 of all job sectors. This shift is also noticeable when looking at the share of only basic industry sectors as Health Care and Social Assistance shrunk from 65% in 2012 to 55% in 2021 (Figure B). The decline in 2021 could be due to the demand Covid-19 placed on the Health Care and Social Assistance industry. Elderly care services experienced an increase in need for individualized attention while still maintaining CDC regulations. In conjunction with the increase in demand, Philadelphia experienced financial instability in the Health Care industry during the Omicron surge of 2021². Across Philadelphia health care professionals were paid late. In 2021 health care professionals in Brewerytown went through their lowest delinquent share since the pandemic began. The increase in demand coupled with late payments likely contributed to professionals leaving and less people joining the industry. In contrast, Philadelphia saw an increase in the Health Care and Social Services industry share from 2012 (26%) to 2021 (31%) of all industries. Although there was a decrease in the share of jobs which came from the Health Care and Social Assistance sector, it remains a basic which shows it is robust during times of uncertainty and strain.

Employment Projections

Brewerytown's employment sector's growth in the past 10 years provides a basis for future employment growth. If these trends continue then in 2030 the neighborhood is projected to have 1,704 jobs. This means that Brewerytown will continue to grow at a faster rate than Philadelphia which is projected to have 545,182 people in 2030 (shown in figure 12). This projection includes the basic industries will remain the same. Health Care and Social Services saw a decrease in the proportional share to all industries likely due to Covid-19. Assuming no major health outbreaks the industry will experience growth in line with neighborhood industry growth. From 2012 to 2022 the population of people employed in Brewerytown increased in relation to those employed in Philadelphia. More people employed in Brewerytown live elsewhere (1054 in 2022) than work and live in the neighborhood (94 in 2022). While the number of people working in Brewerytown and living somewhere else nearly doubled, people working and living in the neighborhood only increased by about 30%. The projections assume this trend will continue, which means the people who live and work in Brewerytown are not experiencing the same amount of economic opportunities as the sectors themselves.

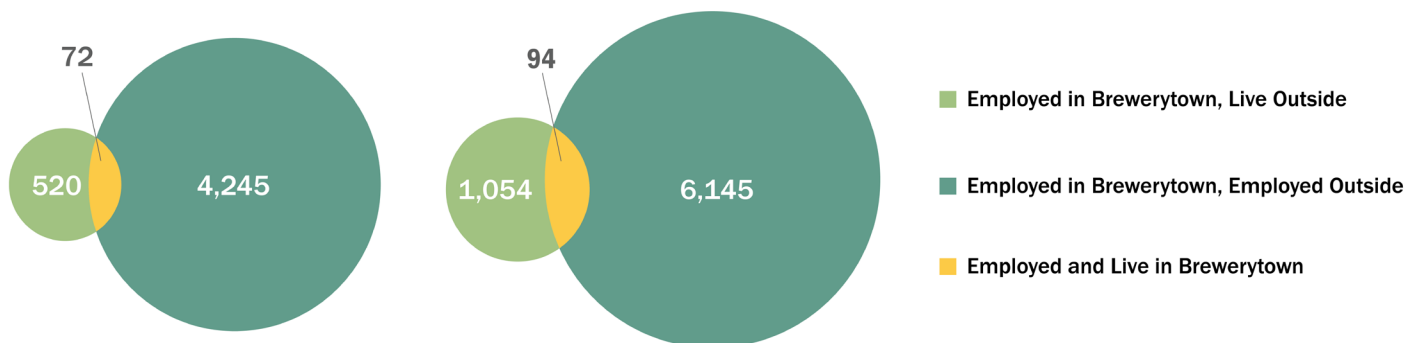


Figure 12: Worker Flows for All Private Jobs in Brewerytown, 2012 & 2022

07 EMPLOYMENT

Among Brewerytown's nearly 14,000 residents over 16, the labor force participation rate is 74.7%. Over the past decade, the neighborhood's labor force has expanded by 45.8%, with the 25-to-44 age group seeing the largest growth, increasing by 83.8%. Both the unemployment rate and the proportion of residents over 16 who are not in the labor force have dropped by more than 10 percentage points, far exceeding the citywide trend (see Figure 12). The inclusion of non-labor force participation acknowledges the factor of "discouraged workers" in the economic vitality (or lack thereof) of an area. In sum, Brewerytown is contributing more to the Philadelphia economy than in the past few decades. The influx of working-age residents indicates a significant demographic shift and economic revitalization taking place in the neighborhood.

However, while the unemployment rate among Black residents has dropped by 57.8%, it remains above 10% (11.5%), which is 4.5 times that of White residents (2.5%). This indicates the uneven employment improvements across different racial groups.

A high proportion of Brewerytown's workforce is employed in professional or white-collar jobs. The largest occupational group in the neighborhood is people working in management, business, science, and arts occupations, with 59.4% of residents in the labor force employed in these fields. Additionally, 14.8% of the working population is employed in sales and office roles. This further underscores the fact that Brewerytown has a predominantly young demographic who are well-educated, working professionals.

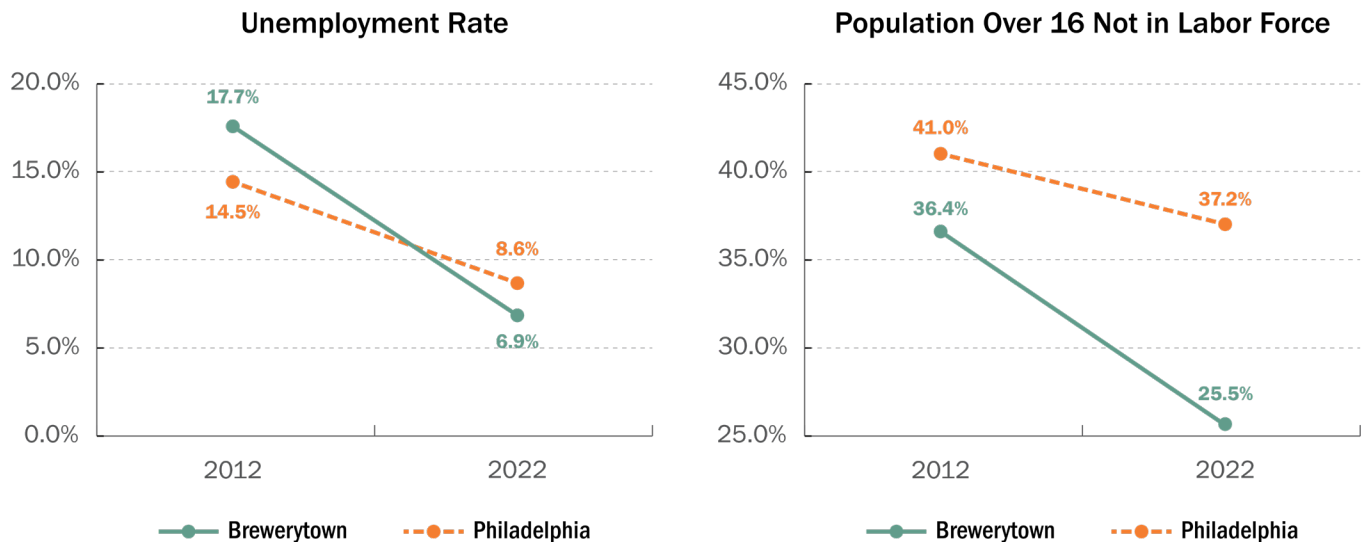


Figure 13: Unemployment Rate & Population Not in Labor Force Over 16

Overview

Household composition is also an important part of neighborhood analysis, as it demonstrates lifestyle changes in living situations which can reveal increasing housing pressures. From 2012 to 2022 the number of households in Brewerytown grew by 35.7% (Figure 14). This growth was much greater than Philadelphia's, which only saw a 13.5% increase in households from 2012 to 2022. The growth in households in Brewerytown compared to Philadelphia should be unsurprising, as the population growth of Brewerytown far outpaced Philadelphia's.

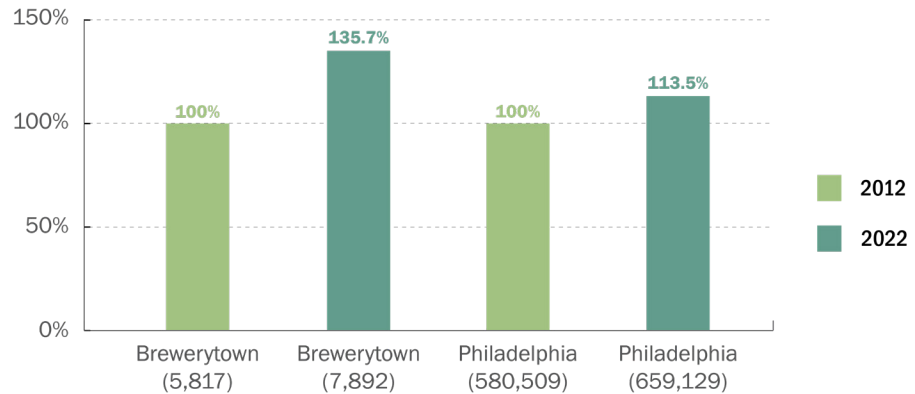


Figure 14: Households Growth as Percent of 2012

Trends in Household Composition

When broken down by family type, more trends emerge from the growth of households in Brewerytown. Of the 2,075 new households in Brewerytown, three main subtypes constituted 83% of the overall change (Figure 15). Non-solo householders constituted the biggest group at 35% of the change, with married-couple families coming in second at 26%, and female householding families at third at 22%. The growth in non-solo householders indicates an increase in roommate living situations (roommates are not considered a family). One of the smallest portions of the 2,075-household increase was for non-family solo living situations. This group indicates individuals living and supporting themselves alone. Despite being the largest single group of households in 2012 and 2022, this group saw very minimal growth. Meanwhile, non-solo households (roommate living situations) grew by 141%, more than doubling from 2012 to 2022. Married couples also showed huge growth over the decade, with a percent change of 46.3%. In comparison, the number of non-family solo-households grew by only 10.1%.



Figure 15: Composition of Households and Household Changes

Household Size

Delving deeper into the household composition changes, Brewerytown also witnessed significant shifts in average household size, usually in conjunction with changes in the number of households. The total average household size in the neighborhood decreased from 2.29 persons per household in 2012 to 2.05 persons per household in 2022 (Figure 16). This decrease was not universal amongst all household groups. Married couple families saw a significant decrease from 3.04 persons per household to 2.66.

On a per-family basis, which means that the average number of children per family is now less than one and quickly approaching 0.5. Within the next few years, only half of the married-couple families in Brewerytown will likely have children present. In similar declines, both male and female-only family households (i.e., without a spouse) also had significant declines in persons per household. Female-family households also had a per person decrease from 3.99 to 3.296. These declines were similar to Philadelphia as a whole, which saw declines in average household size from 2.58 persons per household in 2012 to 2.18 in 2022. Leading the decline in average household size for Philadelphia was once again family households, with married-couple family households, female householder families, and male householder families all declining in average size. Of all the groups, nonfamily households witnessed the smallest decline (from 1.30 in 2012 to 1.23 in 2022).

The biggest takeaway from average household size in Brewerytown, however, was that one group grew in size. Nonfamily households grew in average size from 1.25 persons per household in 2012 to 1.37 persons per household in 2022. In this dataset, both solo and roommate living situations are considered part of “nonfamily” households, which explains the lower per-person count. However, this also means that the per-person increase is almost exclusively made up of an increase in roommate living situations. Thus, the average household size of nonfamily households corroborates the earlier finding that roommate living situations (non-solo households) grew the most in Brewerytown from 2012 to 2022. There could be many reasons why the average nonfamily household size has increased, but one explanation is increasing rent pressure which encourages co-living to decrease the rent burden. The following section examines rent in Brewerytown.

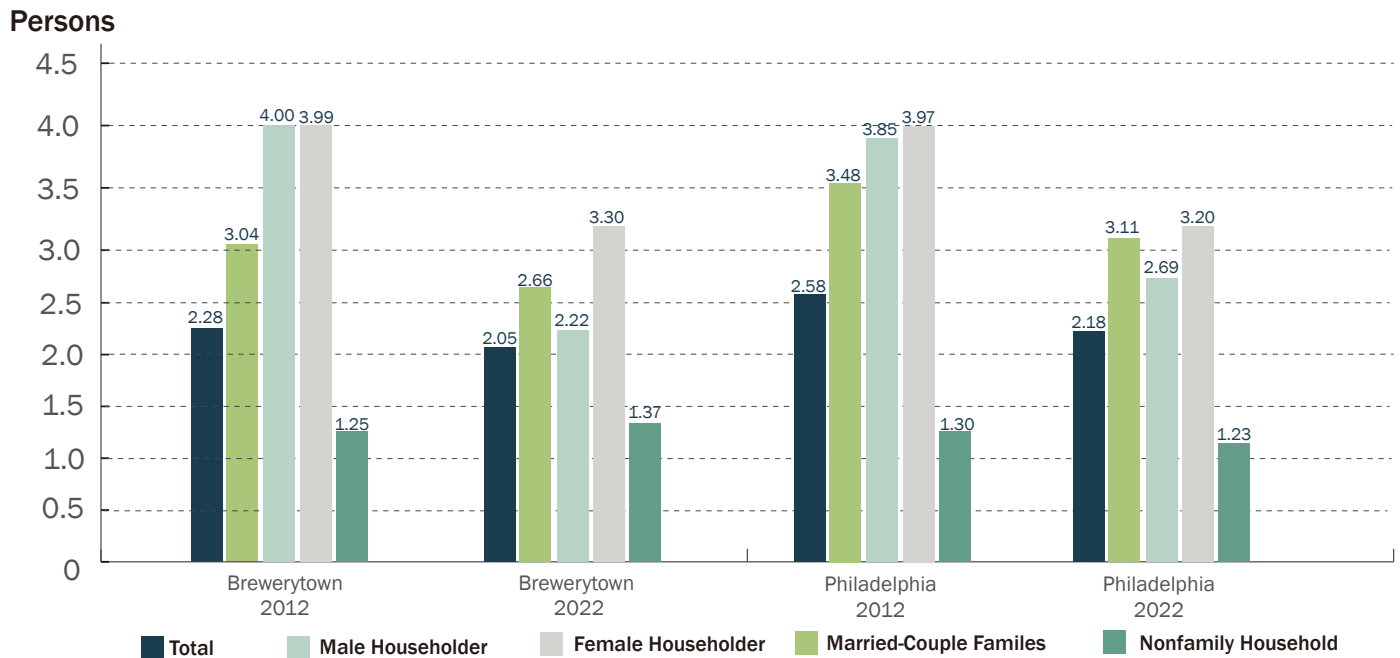


Figure 16: Average Household Size 2012 & 2022

09 RENT & MIGRATION

Overview & Concentration Analysis

Brewerytown experienced significant changes in rent and housing makeup from 2012 to 2022 that set it apart from Philadelphia. While rents increased across the country and in Philadelphia, the changes seen in Brewerytown far outpaced those of the rest of the city. Of the ten highest rent brackets in 2012 and 2022 (cash rent), Brewerytown saw a significant increase in its concentration of high rents compared to Philadelphia (Location Quotient). For instance, the second highest rent bracket in 2022 (\$3,000 to \$3,499) had a LQ of 1.75, compared to only 0.81 in 2012 (for rent \$1,500 to \$1,999) (Figure 17). The highest rent bracket in 2022 also saw its LQ near one, or the Philadelphia baseline. While this means Brewerytown still has a lower percentage of rental units that are \$3,500+ than Philadelphia, it is nearing the same composition. This is an especially stark finding when placed into context with the extremely low LQ of the highest rent bracket in 2012 (\$2,000 or more), which only had an LQ of 0.17. In effect the drastic increase in LQ's of Brewerytown's higher rent brackets means that higher rent apartments are now significantly more concentrated in Brewerytown than Philadelphia.

Rent (2022)	Location Quotient (2022)	Rent (2012)	Location Quotient (2012)
\$2,000 to \$2,499	1.12	\$1,000 to \$1,249	0.54
\$2,500 to \$2,999	1.45	\$1,250 to \$1,499	1.04
\$3,000 to \$3,499	1.75	\$1,500 to \$1,999	0.81
\$3,500 or more	0.91	\$2,000 or more	0.17

Figure 17: Rent Location Quotient 2012 & 2022

Rent Shift

Broken down further, the significant increase in rent is also reflected in a shift in the percentage of renters paying for each rent bracket. In 2012, rent concentrated around the center of the surveyed rent brackets, with 17.81% of individuals paying rent of \$600 to \$699. Yet by 2022, rent had concentrated on the upper price brackets. The largest bracket in 2022 was \$1,500 to \$1,999 at 26.9% of renters. Even when considering inflation (\$1 in 2012 equals \$1.39 in 2022), the largest bracket in 2012 still only paid \$834 to \$971 in 2022 dollars (\$600 to \$699 in inflated dollars). Thus, there has been a shift and concentration of rent towards the upper brackets of rent surveyed in Brewerytown.



Figure 18: Housing Stock in Brewerytown Showing Both New Developments and Older Homes

Low-Income Renters

The concentration and shift of rental prices towards the high-priced units also had a measurable impact on the percentage of income spent on rent by households. While the percentage of individuals paying 50% or more on rent (very rent burdened) remained about the same between 2012 and 2022 (at around 24%), there was a general increase in rent burdened households across brackets (Figure 19, following page). Whereas in 2012 there was a concentration of households paying around 15-20% of their income to rent (at 18.2% of renters), by 2022 this had shifted to 20-25% (at 20.7% of renters). The significant rise in rents in Brewerytown has placed noticeable stress on the neighborhood's low-income population. From 2012 to 2022, the percentage of low-income households (identified in this

report as \$0-50,000) that were rent burdened substantially increased. For instance, the percentage of those who earned less than \$20,000 a year was 100% in 2022 (versus 91.9% in 2012) (Figure 20). The percentage of rent-burdened households from the \$20,000 to \$34,999 income range also skyrocketed to 73% from 51.4% in 2012. Since Black households make up the largest percentage of low-income residents (the following section will discuss this and other income statistics in detail), they will be proportionally more impacted by rising rents. As an example, in 2022, there were over seven times as many black residents that earned less than \$20,000 a year than white households in Brewerytown (1300 versus 182). residents (the following section will discuss this and other income statistics in detail), they will be proportionally more impacted by rising rents. As an example, in 2022, there were over seven times as many black residents that earned less than \$20,000 a year than white households in Brewerytown (1300 versus 182).

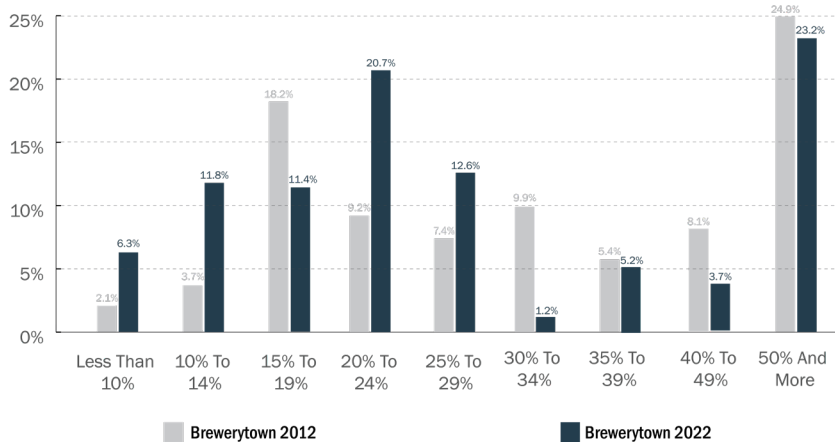


Figure 19: Brewerytown Rent to Income Composition

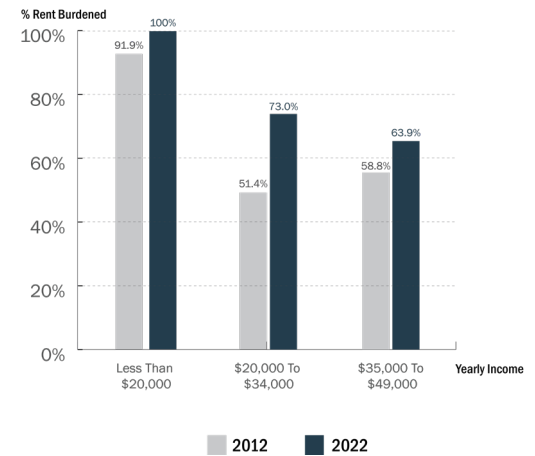


Figure 20: Percent of Rent-Burdened Low-Income Households

Migration

Focusing on the movement of renters in Brewerytown also reveals interesting changes from 2012 to 2022. Using Location Quotient as a measure of concentration, Brewerytown became less concentrated in renters that lived in the same house one year prior (1.25 to 1.05) (Figure 21). On the other hand, it experienced dramatic increases in the concentration of renters who had moved there from other parts of Philadelphia (moved within the same county), and most crucially those who had moved from a different state. On a percentage basis, the percentage of renters who lived in the same house one year ago dropped from 42.5% to 36.5%. Thus, there are fewer long-standing residents of Brewerytown in 2022 than in 2012, and moreover, there are significantly more residents in the community who originated outside Philadelphia or even Pennsylvania. In fact, the relative concentration (LQ) of all renters not originally from the neighborhood was well above that of Philadelphia by 2022. In other words, Brewerytown draws far more residents from outside its boundaries than Philadelphia does.

Total	2012 Percentage	2022 Percentage
Same House 1 Year Ago	41.5%	36.5%
Moved Within Same County	5.5%	8.7%
Moved From Different County Within Same State	1.5%	2.4%
Moved From a Different State	1.0%	3.0%

Figure 21: Neighborhood Migration Brewerytown 2012-2022

10 INCOME & POVERTY

Over the decade from 2012 to 2022, Brewerytown experienced significant household median income growth that far outpaced the citywide trend. The neighborhood's median household income increased by 71.1% from \$42,835 in 2012 to \$73,307 in 2022 (in 2022 inflation-adjusted dollars). In comparison, the median household income in Philadelphia grew from \$45,913 to \$57,537 (25.3%). Moreover, both the absolute number and the percentage of residents living below 150% of the poverty level have declined in Brewerytown. Residents at or above this threshold have increased by 46.1% in number and 11.1 percentage points in share.

Despite the apparent prosperity in income amounts, disparities persist among residents. There are still 29.1% of Brewerytown's households falling below the \$34,999 income threshold; compared to Philadelphia, Brewerytown has a similar proportion of lower-income residents, but a significantly larger share of wealthy residents (annual household income over \$150,000) (Figure 22).

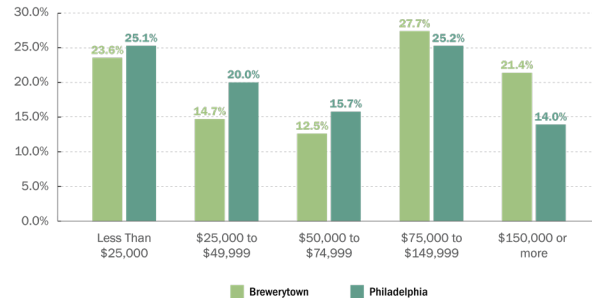


Figure 22: Income Distribution in Brewerytown and Philadelphia

On a per capita basis, the average income for White residents is **2.2** times that of Black residents.

The median income of households with a white householder is **2.7** times the amount of households with a black householder.

The percent growth in White households earning **\$125,000 to \$150,000** was only **47.9%**, compared to a Philadelphia average of **103.4%**.

Comparing the two demographics to each other, in 2012 Black households represented only **34.6%** of all high-income households. Yet by 2022, they represented **49.2%** of the White households.

Families with children are facing financial hardships at a higher rate. Among families with children under 18, 38% live below the poverty level, and the poverty rate is even more concerning for families with children under 5, with 24% falling below the poverty line. In contrast, married-couple families are financially more stable, with only less than 2% of them struggling under the poverty line.

White households in Brewerytown are more concentrated in higher income groups. Whereas Black households show a more dispersed income distribution, with a notably larger share in lower-income brackets compared to White households. The median income of households with a Black householder is about \$37,200, while households with a White householder have a median income of \$100,700. However, this trend may not be as apparent when analyzed at the census tract level. Although the selected census tracts span far less than a mile from end to end, there are distinct socio-economic differences between the tracts. For instance, the number of households with an income over \$200,000 was 429 in tract 136.02 (on the southern edge of Brewerytown) and just 21 for tract 149 (on its northern edge). Thus, although overall economic outcomes have improved for an aggregate of neighborhood households, certain tracts have not experienced such an increase. Acknowledging this condition is critical when determining an overall neighborhood portrait and how neighborhood changes vary across smaller geographies.

Looking closer at the overall income growth trend, Brewerytown has a pattern that different income groups grew at different scales. Changes in high-earning yearly income outpaced that of Philadelphia. For high earners (identified in this report as earning \$75,000 or more each year) Brewerytown generally demonstrated huge increases compared to Philadelphia. For instance, the most dramatic increase was for Black or African American households earning \$150,000 to \$200,000. From 2012 to 2022, there was a 1,475% increase in that group. There also was a similarly massive increase for Black households earning \$125,000 to \$150,000 of 690%. On the other hand, increases in the median income of White households trended more closely with Philadelphia as a whole, or were lower.

On a numeric basis, the number of high-income earners (\$75,000 + per year) for both Black and White households increased dramatically. The number of high-earning White households increased from 1,036 to 2,301. For Black households, the increase was from 359 to 1,133. Thus, from 2012 to 2022 high-income earning households grew in both major groups, with the growth being even more substantial among Black households. If trends continue, the gap in the number of high-income households between the Black and White demographics will continue to narrow. The increased economic outcomes for Brewerytown and both Black and White households within its boundaries represent a growing strength from 2012.

Commuting patterns in Brewerytown have shifted profoundly over the past decade, with the number of residents working from home increasing elevenfold, now comprising over 20% of the total population. Despite a 6% decrease in share, commuting by vehicle remains the dominant method, accounting for over 40%; there are just shy of 20% using public transportation, such as buses or regional rail, and around 15% walking or biking.

The mean travel time to work has decreased by 11.4% over the past decade. However, while the overall trend has shifted to shorter commute times, the number of people commuting for over one hour has increased drastically by 75.5% over the past decade, now accounting for 12.7% of the total share. The COVID-19 pandemic may have contributed to such shift by accelerating remote and hybrid work, which lead individuals to tolerate longer travel time since they need to go to the office less frequently.

From 2012 to 2022, Brewerytown demonstrated a dramatic reversal of its previously high public transit mode share that brought it more in line with Philadelphia's average. The percentage of residents commuting by public transit fell from 31.6% in 2012 to only 19.7% in 2022. Despite the availability of SEPTA buses and light rails, these services may not be perceived as the most convenient choice for residents. Additionally, the increase in work-from-home arrangements might have further reduced the reliance on public transit.



Figure 23: Examples of Public Transportation Stops

Challenges

The two categories of challenges Brewerytown faces stem from increasing populations and inequality. Challenges that arise out of increasing population are public transportation services, sewer capacity and street safety. While growing inequality is seen in rental costs and income.

Public transportation

The public transportation services in Brewerytown include buses and light rail. While in theory the light rail sounds like an efficient alternative, it only runs every 15-20 minutes which is the same regularity as the buses. Additionally, the stops for the light rail are above ground and do not offer shelter from extreme heat or cold for people using public transportation. Bus routes in Brewerytown include the 7, 48, 49 and 32. These buses run every 15-20 minutes, but often are not on time. Some bus stops such as the one-off Girard provide bus shelter, but most do not. With the projected increase in population and employment, reliable public transportation and bus shelters will encourage continued ridership.

Sewer System

The growth in population and employment necessitates an update to the sewer system to accommodate the increase in use.

Street Improvements and Pedestrian Safety

Foot traffic on the streets will also increase, which raises the need for updates for street safety such as more street lighting. The North and Northeast of the neighborhood have less street lighting than places South of Girard Avenue. In the past years community-based organizations focused on creating inviting streets with a focus on the commercial corridor (Girard Avenue). Now is an opportunity to expand these street improvements to the entire neighborhood.

Opportunities

There is much to celebrate in Brewerytown as the strengths and opportunities of the neighborhood provide ways to address the challenges.

Community

The longstanding Black community in Brewerytown creates a sense of identity for the neighborhood while welcoming in newcomers. At the end of the summer there are block parties where families who have lived in the neighborhood for decades celebrate being together and people who moved out return to visit. New community members are invited to attend and have an opportunity to meet their neighbors while enjoying food and music. This provides an opportunity for natural community bonding.

Conversion of Vacant Lots to Mixed-Income Development

The conversion of vacant lots to mixed-income developments provides an opportunity to create inclusive housing for people with various income levels. This will alleviate some of the strain that resulted from the development of luxury apartments and overall rising costs.

Higher Education & the Job Market

From 2012 to 2021 Brewerytown experienced a large rise in the job market. This will bring more revenue to the neighborhood which will enable the expansion of services such as pedestrian safety.

Expansion of Educational Services

In 2021, the educational services industry became a basic industry and higher education rates surged. Based on these trends, more educational services such as those focused on early education and tutoring will continue to emerge in Brewerytown.

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